The Means of Accomplishing Hevajra

Hevajrasādhana · Toh 1264 · Derge Tengyur
དཀྱེས་པའི་རྡོ་རྗེའི་སྒྲུབ་པའི་ཐབས

The Means of Accomplishing Hevajra, in Sanskrit Hevajrasādhana and in Tibetan Dgyes pa'i rdo rje'i sgrub pa'i thabs, is a ritual meditation manual composed by the Indian yogin Anaṅgavajra and translated into Tibetan by the Indian preceptor Samantabhadra and the translator Tsultrim Gyalwa. It sets out, step by step, the practice of visualizing oneself as the deity Hevajra in union with his consort Nairātmyā: establishing the protective boundary, generating the palace and maṇḍala from the elements and seed syllables, arousing the deity through the songs of the goddesses, arraying the eight ḍākinīs such as Gaurī, and receiving empowerment, followed by mantra recitation, offerings, aspirations, and the dissolution of the whole maṇḍala into great bliss. Alongside the sixteen-armed form, it also briefly describes the six-armed and four-armed forms of the deity. The work is Toh 1264 in the Tengyur, where it belongs to the Tantra commentaries section among the sādhanas of the Hevajra cycle.

In the language of India: he vajra sādhanaṃ. In the language of Tibet: The Means of Accomplishing Hevajra.

Homage to Mañjuśrī in youthful form.

Glorious Hevajra, the single body, free of concepts, in the state of supreme bliss,
the nature of all things, moving and still, omitting none, arisen from merit and wisdom alone,
who clears away stains and grows with every joy, protector of the circle of ḍākinīs:
bowing to him with all things, I shall explain his sādhana clearly and at length.

The tradition of the holy guru
is extremely hard to find; what I have heard of it,
having bowed to his lotus feet,
I set down also so that I myself may remember.

Now, there is the yogin who looks upon the realm of sentient beings, wearied by the utter terror of the great abyss of saṃsāra, so fierce and hard to cross, and whose mind is cultivated in the taste of supreme compassion, possessing the means to rescue those who wander in the ocean of saṃsāra; who has

abandoned such faults as contempt for the guru and possesses such qualities as generosity; who has conquered the senses and has been shown the samayas, such as the five nectars; who has been empowered in the maṇḍala taught in the glorious Hevajra and has properly received permission. Such a yogin, staying in some agreeable place such as a charnel ground, on a plot of ground purified with sun, moon, water, scent and special medicines, rises at dawn.

First one should meditate on the taste
of that whose nature is the dharmadhātu.
Making one's abode in its heart,
one should meditate on the supreme state.
Sitting in the vajra posture,
the hands bound in the meditation mudrā,
meditate on rekhā at one's own heart.
From that comes a sun maṇḍala,
and there, arisen from hūṃ,
the very nature of wisdom and means,
black in color and greatly terrifying,
is a vajra arisen from hūṃ.
Abiding at the center of the vajra's hub,
meditate properly on the reality of hūṃ.
Watching the syllable hūṃ transform,
meditate thoroughly on the nature of aversion.
Born from the vajra, the great black one,
with a color like that of a blue lotus:
the form of one's own deity
is of three kinds, according to the instructions.
Among the three, the yogin
should meditate according to his inclination.
The greatly radiant one, the solitary hero,
should be meditated on through faith itself.

Then, placing the innate seed syllable upon the sun at the heart, behold in the sky in front the form of the Blessed One to be meditated on, together with his retinue, invited by its light. The eight goddesses, Gaurī and the rest, who arise from the seed syllable at the heart and are like the stainless autumn sky, holding in the branches of their hands various special offerings and full of grace, worship him in proper order with special outer offerings. Of these, Gaurī

holds the deer-marked moon; Caurī holds the sun; Vetālī, water; Ghasmarī, strength; Pukkasī, scent; Śabarī, taste; Caṇḍālī, the sixth, the lesser one; and Ḍombinī displays the manner of embracing.

Then, in the presence of this very Blessed One, one should perform the confession of the wrongdoing produced by the habitual tendencies of beginningless time, and the rest:

"I confess all the wrongdoing that I have committed, caused others to commit, and rejoiced in when committed. I rejoice in all the roots of virtue, without exception, of all buddhas and bodhisattvas and of ordinary beings. Whatever slight roots of virtue I have produced, I dedicate them all completely to unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening. Thus, until I reach the heart of awakening, I go for refuge to the Buddha Hevajra, the vajra in the form of joy, whose form is the great bliss that is the nature of all things. I go for refuge to the Dharma he taught, whose nature is generation and completion. I go for refuge to the Saṅgha, the host of ḍākinīs who dwell in his circle."

"Having become of the very nature of Heruka, I shall give to these sentient beings sunk in the waters of the ocean of saṃsāra the boat of the teaching of the Vajrayāna Dharma, and, holding them firmly, I shall establish them in that whose character is the aggregate of supreme joy, nondual and like an illusion." In this way I generate the mind set on awakening. "I shall rely on this supreme means, the unsurpassed yoga of Hevajra, than which there is no second for accomplishing unsurpassed buddhahood, the guru." So one should say.

Then one should meditate on great loving-kindness, whose character is cherishing all sentient beings like an only child; on great compassion, the wish to draw them out of suffering and the causes of suffering; on great joy, whose character is bringing great joy to all sentient beings; and on equanimity, whose character is impartiality toward every imagined object without exception.

Then, thinking, "All phenomena are the constructions of mind," one reflects: these things that appear vividly in the aspect of each and every object of mentation are mind itself in error. Just as one is deluded by grief and the like, so this grasped object, other than mind, does not exist. And where there is no grasped object, the grasping mind does not exist either. Therefore these manifold things are to be realized as the nature of mind. Having demonstrated that very point, one should recite the mantra that condenses the essence of the suchness of all things without exception, and dissolve ordinary

appearances:
oṃ śūnyatā jñāna vajra svabhāva ātmako'haṃ

Then, having made the meaning of the mantra directly present, one views all beings as one perceives what appears in a dream, without intrinsic nature, as like the center of the stainless autumn sky, illusion-like, having the character of being free of every form. This itself is called the Blessed Lady Nairātmyā.

Then I, in the form that has arisen as the result concordant with my aspiration and recollection, meditate on the condensed circle as of the nature of a pure world, and imagine in front, upon a seat of a multicolored lotus, a sun maṇḍala arisen from raṃ, and upon it the syllable hūṃ. From it arises a crossed vajra, black in color and terrifying, five-colored and three-pointed. At its center too, upon that sun, one should set the syllable hūṃ.

Upon it, the wrathful one, whose lower part is a spear-point,
Unbearable like the fire at the time of the world's destruction,
His threatening forefinger raised, his left fist at his heart,
Menaces the circle of the māras.
A blazing vajra in his right hand,
His mouth is filled with hūṃ.
The hero wears a tiger's skin
And is adorned with the five mudrās.
The great fierce one, black in color,
Terrifying, utterly terrifying,
Wearing a garland of heads dripping with blood,
The terrifier, the dreadful one, sends forth emanations.
His hair, reddish-yellow, stands on end;
His tongue rolls, and he is in a dancing pose.
He is fully endowed with three eyes,
And his fangs are slightly bared.
In all the directions and intermediate directions
One should send forth hosts of wrathful ones,
And the yogin who knows, by means of this secret mantra,
Should drive in the pegs at his own boundary:
oṃ rakṣa rakṣa hūṃ hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ svāhā, as many times as one wishes.

Within that, the light rays of the sun and of the crossed vajra become one, like the tips of the flames of the fire at the time of destruction, and radiate into the directions and intermediate directions. By this one should imagine the binding

of the boundary, the vajra fence, and above, the vajra tent; and below, from their transformation, a ground of vajra nature reaching down through seven levels beneath.

In its center, from the transformation of hūṃ, arises the form of the source of phenomena (dharmodaya), like the hare-marked autumn moon, the very essence of the great Vajradhara, from which issue manifold masses of greatly wondrous light rays. It is narrow below and wide above, triangular, and in the middle of its hollow interior there is a lotus with petals of various colors and a crossed vajra.

At the hub of that one should view the four great elements, of the nature of the four maṇḍalas, manifold, of the nature of the four goddesses Pukkasī and the rest, one above the other. Of these, first, arisen from yaṃ, is the wind maṇḍala, like a half moon, blue, marked with banners fluttering at its two tips. From raṃ comes the fire maṇḍala, triangular, with a fine point, red, marked with a garland of red light. Above that, arisen from vaṃ, is the water maṇḍala, round, white in color, marked with a vase. Above that, arisen from laṃ, is the earth maṇḍala, square, yellow in color, marked at its corners with three-pointed vajras. Above that, consciousness is imagined as being just like an illusion.

At the hub of the crossed vajra, from the transformation of the four great elements, one should meditate on what is, in brief, a completely pure buddha field: a measureless palace adorned with jewels of every kind, of the nature of the great Vairocana, the purified thirty-seven factors conducive to awakening, encircled by charnel grounds that show the immeasurable and endless world-realms to be like an illusion. It is four-cornered, beautified by eight pillars, made lovely by four gateway enclosures, and ornamented with four porticoes. It is adorned with nets and half-nets, with mirrors and garlands of flowers, with canopies and yak-tail whisks. It is ornamented with vajra lines and beautiful with the hosts of buddhas radiating from it. Fluttering banners are delightful at its pinnacles, and from the doors on every side resounds the sound of bells. It is delightful with the five objects of sensual pleasure well arranged.

In its center is a multicolored lotus of eight petals, with its anthers.

Likewise, on the lotuses in the directions and intermediate directions,
On the anthers of each one's own seat,
Brahmā, Indra, Upendra, and Rudra,

Likewise Yama, the Yakṣa,
Nairṛti, and Vemacitrin:
These, in full, are the seats of Gaurī and the rest.
In the south, the west, the north,
And in the center are the four māras;
Whatever their shape and color,
In just such a form they are to be placed.
In the hearts of all of the māras
There is a sun maṇḍala.
The obstructors, each and every one, are terrified
And strive only to seek refuge.

Then, on the central petal, the vowel letters beginning with a, in forward and reverse order, made twofold, become the moon maṇḍala that signifies the thirty-two major marks of a great being, of the nature of mirror-like wisdom. Above that, the letters beginning with ka, leaving out the letter kṣa and including dha da bha ya ra la va, arising in forward order and in reverse order, twofold, become the sun maṇḍala that signifies the eighty excellent minor marks, of the nature of the wisdom of equality. In its center are the seed syllables hūṃ and aṃ. From their transformation, from the essence of the two seeds resting on their own seats, one should imagine a crossed vajra and a curved knife resting on a skull cup, of the nature of discerning wisdom. From their light rays arise hosts of supreme sages in the guise of ḍākinīs, who survey the immeasurable world-realms and make the sentient beings belonging to them into perfectly complete buddhas; then they return and become one. This is of the nature of the wisdom that accomplishes activities.

Then, transformed from the sun, the moon, the hand emblems, and the seeds, the Blessed One, the great Vajradhara, is fully accomplished from the subtlest particles of incomparable accumulations, of the nature of great bliss, and becomes the cause signified by the arms, faces, color, and shape that will be explained. Such a Nairātmyā, embracing his body, of the nature of the utterly pure sphere of reality (dharmadhātu), should be meditated upon. Such are the five manifest awakenings.

With the mass of light rays issuing from his heart, one makes the entire host of Tathāgatas complete in the form of Heruka, invites them, and makes them enter. They melt, and from that, arisen from the eight seeds beginning with gaṃ, one should send forth and call to mind the ḍākinīs Gaurī and the rest.

Then one beholds in the sky the being of the intermediate state, the gandharva, in the form of a subtle circle, red in color, encircled by two garlands of red ho syllables. Inviting it with light at the heart and making it enter, one should place it in its proper position by means of the guru's personal instruction alone. Then the Vajra-holder together with his own consort melts through great passion; having melted like the stainless autumn moon, one should abide at the culmination of great bliss.

Then the four goddesses, Pukkasī and the rest, come in a manner of intense longing and stay each in her own direction, and with vajra songs that awaken his mind they rouse the Blessed One:

Arise, O savior, whose heart is compassion!
Protect me, Pukkasī.
Give up the very nature of emptiness,
And consent to join with me in great bliss.

If you do not stay, I shall die;
Hevajra, arise!
Give up the very nature of emptiness,
And bring Śabarī's fruit to fulfillment.

O lord, you who tend the world as your guests,
Why do you remain in emptiness?
Without you I know not where to turn;
I, Caṇḍālī, make this supplication.

I know your heart;
You who possess magical display, arise!
I, Ḍombinī, am naked;
Do not cut off the stream of your compassion.

So they sing.

Then, at the very essence of the song, as though waking from a dream, from the gathering of that melted moon arise the two seeds. From their transformation arise the two hand emblems. At their center are those same two seeds, resting on the sun and the moon; one should view them as of the nature of the wisdom of omniscience. From them, through the practice of fully sending forth and fully gathering back Tathāgatas in the form of ḍākinīs, one should infer that all of them depend upon the innate nature of mind, which is like an illusion and like a dream. And one should meditate on oneself as the

form of Heruka, arisen from the transformation of the moon, the sun, the hand emblems, and the seeds, in union with Nairātmyā.

His feet are planted upon the ground;
He menaces the gods and the asuras.
His eyes are red and rolling round;
Wrathful and graceful, with matted locks,
He has four legs and eight faces
And is adorned with sixteen arms.
He tramples at once the four māras:
The aggregates, the afflictions, the Lord of Death, and the son of the gods.
He is in the dancing pose of the half-crossed legs,
With a garland of fifty heads dripping blood,
Utterly terrifying, abiding in a fierce mood.
On the crown of his head he bears a crossed vajra.
His light blazes like the fire at the time of destruction;
From his mouth he proclaims hūṃ,
And his body is smeared with ashes.
His root face and his body
Are like the cloud at the time of destruction and like sapphire.
Like the light of the hare-marked moon
And like the light of the day-maker sun
Are the colors of his right and left faces.
His upper face is the color of smoke.
Grimacing and like bees
Are the remaining four faces.

All his faces have bared fangs and are beautified with three eyes. Above the forehead he is adorned with five skulls. His brows are knit, his reddish-yellow hair stands on end, and he is naked, endowed with the nine moods of the dance.

He is adorned with the five mudrās:
The wheel, the earrings, the necklace,
The bracelets, and the girdle.
Cough and wheezing, likewise weariness,
Wasting, leprosy, and itch,
Dropsy, and disease of the spleen: such is their very nature.
Elephant, horse, ass, ox, camel,
Likewise human, lion, and cat:

In the eight skulls on the right
They should be known in order, beginning with the "twice-drinker," the elephant.
Earth and water, fire and wind,
The moon and the sun,
Antaka and Dhanada (Kubera)
Are in the eight skulls on the left.

The goddess Nairātmyā
Is adorned with two arms.
With a skull cup filled
With the blood of the four māras her left hand is occupied;
In her right she holds
A curved knife that cuts off the afflictions.
Naked and black in color,
She embraces the Blessed One at the neck.
She is adorned with three eyes,
And stands in the posture with the right leg extended.
She is adorned with the five mudrās;
Above her forehead a garland of dry heads
Beautifies her with its beauty.
With a garland of bloodless heads
The accomplished ḍākinī is adorned.

Then, on the sun resting on the lotus at the Blessed One's heart, there is hūṃ. Then, on the moon resting on the lotus at the Blessed Lady's heart, one should view the letter aṃ. On the lotuses at the eyes, ears, nose, tongue, body, and mind, and upon the moon maṇḍala at the heart where the life-breath has gone, there arise, born from the seeds a ā i ī uṃ, the curved knife as the emblem, and the moon and sun joined face to face. From their transformation arise the ḍākinīs Vajrā and the rest, white, black, yellow, red, and green, who are delusion, aversion, slander, desire, and jealousy, of the nature of the ḍākinī Nairātmyā. One should meditate on them holding curved knife and skull cup and seated in the dance of the half-maṇḍala posture. These five ḍākinīs, Vajrā and the rest, should be imagined, in their respective order, as the aggregates of form, feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness.

Likewise, for delusion, aversion, pride, slander, desire, jealousy, and the objects such as form, there are Gaurī, Caurī, Vetālī, Ghasmarī, Bhūcarī, and

Khecarī; and for earth, water, fire, wind, and space there are Pukkasī, Śabarī, Caṇḍālī, and Ḍombinī. For body, speech, and mind, upon the moon maṇḍala at the heart from which evil has departed, born from the seeds oṃ āṃ, the yoginīs, the White One, the Red One, the Black One, Bhūcarī, Khecarī, and Nairātmyā, are stationed, fully complete in the same way as Vajrā and the rest.

Flesh is known as Pukkasī;
Blood is held to be Śabarī;
Caṇḍālī is taught to be semen;
Ḍombinī is the purified marrow and fat.
These are the purities of the deities.

Now the other purities shall be stated:

The skin is the seven limbs of awakening;
The bones are the four noble truths.
The eyes of compassion are red;
Through a heart of loving-kindness the limbs are black.
By the four means of attracting disciples
The four feet should be recalled.
The eight faces are the liberations;
The arms are the sixteen emptinesses.

The measure is the five buddhas;
The wrath is the tamer of the wicked;
The eyes are the purified three vajras;
Through the mind that relies on this, accomplishment comes.
Sixty-four, eight, and sixteen,
And the lotus of thirty-two petals:
Emanation, Dharma, Enjoyment,
And the one called Great Bliss, in that order,
At the navel, heart, throat, and head:
These four wheels should be meditated upon.
The five rays, white and black,
Red, and blue, likewise;
oṃ hūṃ aṃ haṃ, as is fitting,
Facing upward and downward,
Through the purity of wisdom and means,
Are shown in pairs.

Then, with the mass of light rays of the innate seed at one's own heart, one invites the host of supreme Victors who dwell in the three realms, established from the very beginning, and requests them to be seated in the sky. One worships them fully with the special outer, inner, and secret offerings, and supplicates them with oṃ abhiṣiñcatu māṃ sarbatathāgata. Then those Tathāgatas, who have taken the form of Heruka, as the nature of the five Tathāgatas, holding in their lotus hands five vases of the nature of the five nectars, confer empowerment. Immediately upon the empowerment, the Lord of the mind is placed on the crown of the head. A rain of flowers and a rain of saffron also fall, the sound of drums resounds, Rūpavajrā and the others make offerings, and Buddhalocanā and the others sing praises. After that, one meditates that through the empowerment conferred by one's own awareness abiding at the heart, the eyes and the other senses are obtained; and, in order to increase the accumulations, one should consecrate oneself with the five families.

This is the sequence for it. At the head, the heart, the navel, the secret place, and the thighs, one should meditate on bodies accomplished from the subtlest particles of the nature of Vairocana, Akṣobhya, Ratnasambhava, Amitābha, and Amoghasiddhi, completed from the five seeds oṃ hūṃ sva āḥ hā.

On the anthers of an eight-petaled lotus, arisen from the seeds hūṃ and ā, the yogin's vajra jewel, arisen from hūṃ and oṃ, is consecrated as is fitting with the two mantras: oṃ padma sukha dhara mahā rā rāga sukha dhara catur ānanda bhaga biśā hūṃ hūṃ hūṃ karyaṃ kuruṣva me and catur ānanda dayaka khaga mukhe karā so nātha hūṃ hūṃ hūṃ karyaṃ kuruṣva me. With these one should commence the joy together with her. All that has been described thus far is the samādhi called the First Yoga.

After that, with the light-hook of the seed at one's own heart, one invites the circle of Heruka, makes it enter oneself, and causes it to melt. Having become like a melted moon, it falls into the lotus, and from that comes the generation. From their own seeds and hand emblems one generates the completed lord of the maṇḍala and the host of ḍākinīs, Gaurī and the rest, and emanates and sends them forth with the emitting mantra hūṃ aṃ gaṃ caṃ baṃ ghaṃ paṃ śaṃ laṃ ḍaṃ. There one should place oneself as the Blessed One together with the Blessed Lady, characterized by the arms, faces, body color, and so on, as taught.

Gaurī is black in color;
In her right and her other hand she holds a curved knife
And a rohita fish;
One should imagine her on a sun seat at the eastern gate.

Likewise, Caurī, colored like madder, holding a small drum and a pig, is on the southern seat. Likewise, Vetālī, colored like refined gold, holding a tortoise and a lotus vessel, is on the seat of the western gate. Likewise, Ghasmarī is like an emerald, holding a snake and a yogic vessel, on the seat of the northern quarter. Likewise, Pukkasī is like sapphire, holding a lion and an axe, on the seat of the northeastern corner, that of Īśāna. Likewise, Śabarī is like the full moon, holding a monk and a ringed staff, on the seat of the southeastern corner, that of Fire. Likewise, Caṇḍālī is pale blue like the sky, holding a wheel and a plough, on the seat of the southwestern corner, that of Nairṛti. Likewise, Ḍombinī is of many colors, holding a vajra in her hand and making the threatening gesture; one should imagine her abiding on the seat of the northwestern corner, that of Wind.

All the vajra yoginīs
Stand in the dance of the half-crossed legs,
Adorned with the five mudrās;
Their hair, reddish-yellow, stands on end;
Their three eyes are red and round;
Adorned with garlands
Of bloodless human heads,
Naked, they bestow supreme bliss upon their lord.

Having thus viewed the maṇḍala complete in every respect:

Through the practice of the mudrā consecration,
In order to attain undiminished wisdom,
In the openings of the lotus and the vajra
One should imagine a yellow phaṭ.

Then, with the light-hook of the seed at one's own heart, one invites the wisdom maṇḍala, and looking toward the eastern gate one presents water for welcoming and the other offerings: oṃ bajra gaurī ākarṣaya jaḥ oṃ bajra caurī brabeśaya hūṃ oṃ bajra betālī bandha baṃ oṃ bajra ghasmarī tośaya hoḥ. With these one invites them, makes them enter, binds them, and pleases them, and one imagines that the pledge maṇḍala and the wisdom maṇḍala have become one. Then, with the light rays of the seed at the heart, one

should invite the host of supreme Victors, make offerings to them, and request them to confer empowerment. As soon as they have thus conferred the empowerment, the Victor who conferred the name empowerment comes to abide upon the head.

There, with the seals of the Mind, the Buddha, the Jewel,
And the Vajra-Dharma,
Gaurī, Caurī, Vetālī,
And Ghasmarī are sealed in that order;
The four goddesses, Pukkasī and the rest,
By these same buddhas, in that order.

Then the ḍākinīs who issue from the gateway of the light rays of the seed at one's own heart hold up in their branch-like hands offerings of every kind: substances, sights, and every virtue, whose essence is the vision of all as like an illusion. With these, and with other special outer offerings, one should worship fully the circle of the maṇḍala, whose very nature is the three realms, without forming any notion of a distinction between the offerer, the offering, and the recipient of the offering. And one should also praise it, knowing the city of sound to be like an echo.

Surrounded by the host of yoginīs,
Your mind attains the supreme.
Through it you purify beings, the stable and the moving;
With a heart of compassion you raise up sentient beings;
As an illusory emanation you launch the vajra.
Glorious Blood-Drinking Vajra, hold me in your heart!

Then, in front, arisen from yaṃ, is the wind maṇḍala, marked with a banner. Above it, arisen from raṃ, is the fire maṇḍala, marked by blazing flames. Above it, arisen from aṃ, is a lotus vessel. In its center are the five nectars and the five lamps, marked with the seeds of the five Tathāgatas. Through kindling, stirring, and purifying them until they are stainless, they become like crystal. Above it is a vajra arisen from hūṃ, blessed by all the Tathāgatas, and through its light the contents melt. They are blessed by oṃ, and with its light rays one draws in the wisdom nectar of all the Tathāgatas and makes it of one taste with them, and they are blessed by the three realities. Of the nature of taste, potency, and incomparable ripening, with tongues arisen from hūṃ, one should satisfy the maṇḍala arranged at the heart and upon the sun; and the principal one, meditated upon as abiding in the midst of the ḍākinīs, is likewise

satisfied with that same nectar. This is the samādhi called the Supreme Victory of the Maṇḍala.

Now, having fully sent forth into the ten directions the host of ḍākinīs, Gaurī and the rest, and the lord of the maṇḍala, each one in order to the very last, and having made them steady as is fitting, when they have performed their work and done their activity, one should view the entire maṇḍala as nonconceptual, of the nature of bliss.

After that, first, the wheel of emanation is the letter aṃ, black in color, together with its light. From its transformation, light rays blazing like the light of a lamp issue from the pores of the skin, illuminating the host of goddesses, Gaurī and the rest; and one should meditate on sending forth and gathering back the maṇḍala and the lord of the maṇḍala, whose body is deep black like ground collyrium. In this same sequence one should meditate on the six limbs: the second red, the third yellow, the fourth green, the fifth blue, and the sixth white. Afterward it is likewise, up to the culmination of the joy of cessation. Thus the eight ḍākinīs, Gaurī and the rest, abiding in the eight faces turned toward their respective directions, are made to rest in the innate seed at one's own heart. Then one should imagine that the Blessed Lady Nairātmyā too abides at the Blessed One's heart.

Then the Blessed One also, sending forth hosts of light rays from the four wheels, himself becomes of the nature of light, and so should enter into the innate seed resting on the sun at his own heart. The sun, too, dissolves into the seed, and the seed into the drop; and the three wheels together with the drop, signified by it, should be meditated upon as of the nature of great bliss, in the form of a mass of white light rays. As it gradually melts into one's own self, one should make it beyond any object of reference. It is said that thus the innate essential nature of mind becomes of one taste in the form of great bliss.

If one grows weary of meditation, one should recite mantra. Imagining oneself in the form of the wheel, one recites the mantra oṃ deba picu bajra hūṃ hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ svāhā, or the root mantra given in the tantra. On the sun at the heart, the blazing letters of the mantra, standing upright, perfectly arranged in the form of a circle, are written by the mind and viewed by the mind: this is the vajra recitation. Or else one may do the wrathful recitation, in which one should intently imagine that the eight faces and the ḍākinīs, Gaurī and the rest, utter the mantra from their mouths. This is the recitation in brief.

If one grows weary of recitation, one should make an aspiration:

Born in a noble family and keeping the pledges,
Without arrogance, a holder of Hevajra,
Devoted to the guru and endowed with compassion,
May I be born so, birth after birth.
My hands ringing the vajra and bell,
Reciting the profound Dharma,
Partaking together of the consort's fluid,
May I be born so, birth after birth.

Or else, as before, one should fully worship the circle of the retinue of one's own chosen deity, and from the innate seed at one's own heart intently imagine the palace as vast and extensive. Having meditated that the host of ḍākinīs is gathered within it, one should maintain the very pride of the deity. Rising with this frame of mind, one should go about one's activities.

In the other two sessions as well, one sits down in an agreeable place and, as before, intently imagines the palace. In its center, in the eight-faced form, oneself united with Nairātmyā, one pronounces the three realities, and thereby clearly beholds the host of ḍākinīs emerging, each with her own activity, and arranges them in their proper places. Meditating on the entire circle of the maṇḍala as of the nature of great bliss, one should also make offerings, praises, and so on. At the time of lying down to sleep, one should make manifest the yoga that culminates in the joy of cessation and then fall asleep. At the time of waking, one imagines that one rises, roused by the songs of the four goddesses, Pukkasī and the rest. Having risen, one should remain in just that way. One should do this every day until one attains perfect and complete awakening. This is the samādhi called the Supreme Victory of Action.

If one is inclined to the sixteen-armed form, in that same palace one should meditate on the six-armed or the four-armed form. There, the Blessed One's own seed, hand emblems, and so on are the six perfections. Through the purity of emptiness, signlessness, and wishlessness he has three faces. His body and root face are like a blue lotus; the left face is red; the right is like moonlight. He is three-eyed and stands in the half-crossed posture. In his first right hand is a vajra, in the second a curved knife; in his first left hand a trident, in the second a bell. With his remaining hands he embraces Vajraśṛṅkhalā in union; he whose nature is the three realms presses down upon a corpse. Vajraśṛṅkhalā is blue in color and, like Nairātmyā, adorned with various ornaments. One should meditate that with her two hands, holding a curved knife and a skull cup, she embraces her own innate lord at the neck.

Likewise, through the purity of having utterly vanquished the māras, he has four arms and is like a blue lotus. He is three-eyed, tramples upon a corpse, and presses it down in the dance of the half-crossed legs. In his first right hand is a vajra. In his first left hand is a human skull cup filled with the blood of gods and asuras. With his remaining hands he embraces Vajravārāhī. The Blessed Lady is blue in body color, and in her right and other hand she holds a curved knife and a skull cup. The hand emblems and the wheels of these causal vajra-holders are also like those of the fruition; in particular, one should meditate on a moon seat and the light of the moon. Although the six-armed and four-armed forms do not have eight faces, the host of ḍākinīs should be placed in the pores of the skin, each in her own direction.

oṃ kiṭi kiṭi bajra hūṃ hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ svāhā is the mantra of the six-armed form. oṃ jvala jvala bhyo hūṃ hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ svāhā is the mantra of the four-armed form. The rest should be understood as before.

The glorious Anaṅgavajra,
Having attained inconceivable wisdom
And received genuine authorization,
Wrote this, and not out of conceit.
Whatever errors I have made in writing this,
May the learned, whose minds
Are like the stainless light of autumn,
And the yogins kindly forbear.
Whatever good I have gathered
By composing this sādhana of the Blood Drinker,
Through it may all the worlds without exception
Reach the far shore of omniscient wisdom.

The sādhana of glorious Hevajra, composed by the glorious yogin Anaṅgavajra, is complete. It was translated, edited, and finalized by the Indian preceptor Samantabhadra and the translator, the monk Tsultrim Gyalwa.

Translator's Notes

• "The lesser one" renders the obscure □□□□□□, the sixth offering held by Caṇḍālī; its sense is uncertain. □□□□□ in the opening verse is read as □□□□□□, "state", and □□□□□□□□ in the confession as □□□□□□□, "committed".
• The lower half of the wrathful protector is described as a spear-point, evidently in the manner of a kīla deity whose lower body is a peg. The goddesses' eight seats follow the Hevajra Tantra's list of trampled gods: "the Yakṣa" (gnod sbyin) is the lord of yakṣas, i.e. Kubera, and

thags bzangs ris is the asura king Vemacitrin. The verse names only south, west, north, and center for the four māras; this is rendered as it stands. The gandharva here is the consciousness of the being between death and rebirth.
• In the description of the root face, sbyin is read as sprin, "cloud," since "the cloud at the time of destruction" is the evident sense. "lag pa gang du bu" is taken as lag pa'i gdu bu, "bracelets." In the placement of the ḍākinīs, □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ is read as □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□, "lotuses at the mind"; the phrase srog song ba'i snying ga, "the heart where the life-breath has gone," is translated literally, and its precise sense is uncertain (a later parallel has sdig song ba, "from which evil has departed"). The lists of goddesses and their correspondences are given as the text has them, though the numbers of items do not match one for one.
• The line giving the petals of the four wheels reads "sixty-four, eighty-six"; brgyad cu drug is taken as brgyad bcu drug, "eight, sixteen," since four wheels of sixty-four, eight, sixteen, and thirty-two petals are evidently meant. In the list of five rays only four colors are named, as in the Tibetan. In Ḍombinī's description, phyag na rdo rje is "a vajra in her hand," not the name Vajrapāṇi.
• The line rendered "you launch the vajra" reads rdo rje phong; it is taken as 'phong, "shoot, launch," and the sense is uncertain. The conditional "if one is inclined to the sixteen-armed form, ... meditate on the six-armed or the four-armed form" is translated as it stands, though one might expect "if one is not inclined." Nag po chen po here describes the deep black body of the maṇḍala's lord, not the deity Mahākāla. The "joy of cessation" (viramānanda) is the third of the four joys.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.